

AN ECO-CONSCIOUS CHOICE

Another reason for the pick-up in luxury EV sales is environmental awareness. “Customers want to make an active contribution in reducing the carbon footprint. When great product attributes meet green solutions, the proposition becomes even more attractive. Young achievers, especially, are very conscious about sustainable choices,” says BMW’s Brar. The share of EVs in BMW India’s portfolio has risen from 3% to 18% in the last three years.

According to Mercedes-Benz’s Iyer, electric mobility in the luxury segment is all about eco-sensitivity and value. “Initially, BEV purchase was a status symbol and a differentiator. With increasing penetration, it’s more about intelligent choice. India’s favourable taxation has created interesting dynamics. BEVs are more cost-effective. So, customers are making rational decisions alongside aspirational ones,” says Iyer.

76 | While high and ultra-high networth individuals don’t want to hold back spending, they also want to be viewed as responsible and progressive. “The idea of ‘guilt-free opulence’ is gaining traction. We believe it will become a significant driver of luxury consumption in India. Customers want indulgence but also want their choices to reflect responsibility,” says Audi’s Dhillon.

BMW’s Brar says luxury car buyers are not just looking at a price tag to stand out. “They want something personal and authentic, with a story that incites emotions. EV customers are not looking for just an electric powertrain but also a brand genuinely committed to sustainability. Beyond the technical aspects and charging modules, they are also interested in aspects such as how the vehicle was produced, are the materials sustainable, what are the other measures through which BMW is contributing to CO₂ reduction?” says Brar.

WEALTH OF CHOICES

The trend is not without challenges. Some luxury carmakers are backing away from targets due to a slump in EV sales in the US and Europe owing to global geopolitical un-

